Chapter 9: Value of Good Financial Decision-Making in Retirement

In the previous chapters, I sought to provide context for how a retirement income strategy can extend beyond traditional wealth management to better manage the many risks of retirement.

As we approach the end of this story, this final chapter will turn more toward the process of good financial decision-making for retirement and the benefits it can provide to retirees. I will start by explaining more about my own background within the financial services profession, including the roles I play as an educator at the American College of Financial Services and my Retirement Researcher website, and my role in providing financial planning services as a principal at McLean Asset Management.

My career decisions do incentivize me to encourage readers to work with financial planners. However, my primary focus is on education, and this is true going back to the days when I started the Retirement Researcher blog while still working as an economics professor in Japan with no connection to the financial services world. I am glad to guide readers toward high-quality advisors who can provide net positive impacts on their personal finances. I am also glad to empower and educate readers on how to do this on your own.

I continue the chapter by describing how good decisions impact a financial plan relative to poor decisions. Then I will describe the challenges that we as humans must overcome to make good financial decisions. I have made an effort to provide sufficient information for individuals to construct retirement income plans on their own. However, I recognize that some readers may decide they do not have the time, patience, or inclination to do it all on their own. Thus, I also explain how the financial advisory profession works and what McLean Asset Management is able to do to help you build an efficient retirement income plan.